

Quiche Zoubee

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Fresh zoubee, creamy Akkawi and black olives bring a Lebanese flavour to this golden quiche.

Serves 6–8 · Prep 25 min · Cook 1 h

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE PASTRY

- 2 cups plain flour
- 1 tbsp ground za'atar
- 125 g cold butter, cubed
- 1 egg yolk
- Approximately 4 tbsp cold water

FOR THE FILLING

- 1 cup crème fraîche
- 1 egg
- 1 cup diced Akkawi cheese
- 1 cup fresh zoubee leaves (wild oregano), washed and thoroughly dried
- 12 black olives, pitted and roughly chopped
- 1 cup shredded mozzarella
- ½ cup shredded cheddar

METHOD

1. Make the pastry. Combine the flour and ground za'atar in a bowl. Rub in the cold butter with your fingertips until the mixture resembles coarse breadcrumbs.
2. Add the egg yolk, then the cold water gradually, mixing just until the dough comes together. You may not need all the water. Shape into a disc, wrap and refrigerate for 30 minutes.
3. Prepare the shell. Preheat the oven to 180°C. Roll the pastry on a lightly floured surface and use it to line a 24 cm tart tin. Ease it into the corners without stretching, then trim the edges. Prick the base lightly with a fork.
4. Blind-bake. Line the pastry with baking paper and fill with baking weights or dried beans. Bake for 15 minutes. Remove the paper and weights, then bake for another 5–10 minutes, until the base looks dry and lightly coloured.
5. Make the filling. Whisk the crème fraîche and egg together until smooth. Fold in the Akkawi, zoubee leaves, olives, mozzarella and cheddar.
6. Fill and bake. Spoon the filling into the pastry shell and spread evenly. Bake for approximately 30–35 minutes, until golden on top and just set in the centre.
7. Rest and serve. Leave to settle for 10 minutes before removing from the tin and slicing. Serve warm with a fresh salad.

Tip

Keep the butter and water cold. This helps create a crisp, tender pastry.

Watch Nell make it